



Digital Democracy Initiative

Branding

AND COMMUNICATIONS STRATEGY

VISUAL IDENTITY GUIDELINES
FOR DDI SOUTH ASIA



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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of the Document

This Branding & Communications Strategy outlines the visual identity, messaging standards, logo usage protocols, and communication practices for the DDI South Asia, implemented under the global Digital Democracy Initiative.

This document ensures that all communication materials including digital, print, social media, events, research products, and outreach content, reflect one cohesive identity and adhere to donor-required branding rules.

1.2 Scope of Application

This guideline applies to all implementing partners, subgrantees, designers, consultants, communications officers, and project staff producing content under DDI South Asia.

1.3 Non-Negotiable Requirements

According to guidelines:

- The Digital Democracy Initiative logo must appear at the top (usually top-left).
- CIVICUS, DDI South Asia and Accountability Lab logos must be placed at the bottom-right, followed by partner logos.
- Logos must not be altered, recoloured, stretched, or redesigned.
- Approval is required for Information, Education, and Communication (IEC) materials.

1.4 Communications Focal Person

For any questions, clarifications, or approval needs related to branding, logo placement, or communications compliance, please contact the communications manager (via mabubakar@accountabilitylab.org). All DDI South Asia implementing partners should coordinate with the Communications Manager to ensure materials comply with DDI South Asia requirements.

2. Brand Architecture

DDI South Asia is a regional identity within the global Digital Democracy Initiative.

The architecture consists of:

Primary identity (mandatory):

- Digital Democracy Initiative logo
- CIVICUS logo (bottom right, before the DDI South Asia logo)

Secondary regional identity (mandatory):

- DDI South Asia logo



Implementing partners

- Accountability Lab logo (on right side after DDI South Asia logo)
- Subgrantee logo (your organisation at bottom-right after Accountability Lab logo)

3. Logo Usage Guidelines

3.1 Digital Democracy Initiative Logo (Mandatory)

Placement Rules:

- Always placed top-left on all materials.
- Size should be prominent but not overshadow the message.

Do NOT:

- Edit colours
- Rotate or distort
- Add effects or filters
- Place on cluttered backgrounds

3.2 CIVICUS Logo (Mandatory)

Placement Rules:

- Always placed bottom right (first logo from left to right) on all IEC material.
- Size should be prominent but not overshadow the message.

Do NOT:

- Edit colours
- Rotate or distort
- Add effects or filters
- Place on cluttered backgrounds

3.3 DDI South Asia Logo (Mandatory)

Placement Rules:

- On bottom right of the IEC material (after CIVICUS logo)
- On digital banners, social media posts, and backdrop designs
- Cannot appear above the official DDI logo.

Clear Space and Minimum Size

- Maintain a clear space equal to half the height of the “D” arc around all sides.
- Minimum digital size: 180 px width
- Minimum print size: 25 mm width



3.4 Accountability Lab Logo (Mandatory)

Placement Rules:

- On bottom right of the IEC material after DDI South Asia logo
- On digital banners, social media posts, and backdrop designs
- Cannot appear above the official DDI logo.

3.5 Logos on General Materials

Top-left:

- Digital Democracy logo

Bottom-right (left to right order):

- CIVICUS logo
- DDI South Asia logo
- Accountability Lab logo
- Your organisation logo

3.6 Large Banners / Event Backdrops

- Digital Democracy Initiative logo top-left or centre
- Title centered
- CIVICUS + DDI South Asia + Accountability Lab + partner logos bottom-right

3.7 Videos

Opening frame:

- Fade-in: Digital Democracy Initiative logo
- Bottom-right watermark: DDI South Asia logo
- End frame: DDI South Asia + Accountability Lab + partners logos in required order

CIVICUS logo would not be used on digital banners/ posters/ videos and website material.

3.8 Certificates

- Top-left: Digital Democracy Initiative logo
- Bottom right: CIVICUS + DDI South Asia, Accountability Lab, partners

3.9 Logo Variations for DDI South Asia

3.9.1 Full-Colour Primary Version (Green Gradient)

Usage:

- White backgrounds
- Light grey backgrounds
- Office documents



- Reports, banners

3.9.2 Solid Black Version

Usage:

- When printing restrictions require single colour
- Newspaper ads / photocopied documents

3.9.3 White Reversed Version

Usage:

- On fully black or dark backgrounds
- On coloured social media templates

4. Colour Palette

Primary Colours (from DDI South Asia logo)

Colour	Hex	RGB
Dark Green	#24684A	36,104,74
Mid Green	#3BA879	59,168,121
Light Green	#59C48C	89,196,140
Black	#000000	0,0,0
Charcoal Grey	#333333	51,51,51

Neutral Colours

Colour	Hex	RGB
White	#FFFFFF	255,255,255
Light Grey	#F3F3F3	243,243,243

5. Typography

Typography ensures consistency, readability, and a professional visual appearance across all DDI South Asia communication assets. The following font families and size hierarchy must be used across all materials unless otherwise specified.



5.1 Approved Font Families

Primary Typeface – Aptos Family

For all DDI South Asia IEC materials, the Aptos family is the core brand typeface.

Use these variations:

- Aptos Display
- Aptos Narrow
- Aptos Regular / Bold

Secondary Typeface – Arial

Use when Aptos is not available or for simpler documents.

Digital Typeface – Inter

Use for:

- Digital content
- Web-based templates
- Social media assets
- UI/UX content
- Captions and light text

5.2 Font Size Hierarchy

Text Style	Font Size	Usage
Title	24 pt	Report covers, banners, hero headings
Subtitle	18 pt	Secondary titles, section intros
Main Heading	16 pt	Section titles inside documents
Subheading	14 pt	Subsections, bold pointers
Body Text	12 pt	Regular paragraphs, captions, bullet points
Table Text	11 pt	Regular table text, bullet points

5.3 Usage Rules

- Titles must be Bold.
- Main headings must be Bold.
- Avoid using more than two fonts at once (single font family preferred).
- Maintain consistent spacing:
- Line spacing: 1.15

5.4 Accessibility Considerations

- Minimum font size for digital use: 12 pt
- Avoid extremely light weights of Aptos for paragraphs
- Ensure high colour contrast for text on backgrounds

- Use Inter for small bodies of text to maintain clarity on screens

6. Photography & Videography Standards

6.1 Consent Forms

As required:

- All participants must sign consent forms.

6.2 Photography Style

- Real, contextual, non-staged, human-centered photography
- Diverse representation from across South Asia
- Avoid: overly edited images, glamour filters, or stock images without relevance

6.3 Videography Style

- Clean subtitles in English
- Audio quality above 48kHz

7. Communication Strategy

7.1 Overall Goal

To establish DDI South Asia as a credible, visible, and regionally grounded initiative that strengthens digital rights, civic tech capacity, and democratic resilience in South Asia, aligned with global Digital Democracy Initiative communications protocols.

7.2 Key Audiences

Audience	Communication Purpose
Stakeholders	Reporting, alignment, credibility
Donors	Progress visibility, brand compliance
Youth activists & CSOs	Engagement, capacity-building
Policymakers	Advocacy, influence
Media	Awareness & amplification
General public	Digital rights awareness

7.3 Core Messaging Pillars

1. Digital Rights & Civic Space

Accessible digital ecosystems where citizens can safely engage.



2. **Countering Digital Authoritarianism**

Strengthening resilience against repression, surveillance, and information threats.

3. **Civic Tech for Democracy**

Empowering local actors with digital tools, training, and partnerships.

4. **South Asian Collaboration**

Regional learning, community building, and shared digital democracy solutions.

7.4 Tone of Voice

- Professional and authoritative
- Rights-based and inclusive
- Evidence-driven
- Regionally contextual
- Non-political, non-partisan

8. Templates & Formats

8.1 Reports, Manuals, Research Papers

Mandatory:

- Official DDI logo at top-left
- CIVICUS, DDI South Asia, Accountability Lab and partner logos bottom right (arranged left to right) respectively.
- Consistent header/footer
- Standardized font usage
- Cover page design

8.2 Social Media Templates

- Aspect ratios: 1:1, 4:5, 16:9 (9:16 for vertical content)

8.3 Event Branding

- Complete branding collateral must follow the required order of logo placement

9. Approval Workflow

9.1 Content Requiring Approval

- Manuals
- Toolkits
- Research tools
- Videos
- High-visibility campaigns



- Press releases
- Event branding
- Event agenda
- All reporting documents must adhere to provided templates including milestone reports, final project report, attendance sheet and financial report.

9.2 Content Not Requiring Approval

- Routine social media posts
- Internal workshop reminders
- Stories, reels, informal updates
- Behind-the-scenes content

Still recommended: share monthly communications plan.

10. File Management & Distribution (for CPOs)

Maintain a central folder with:

- All logo versions (PNG, JPG, SVG, EPS)
- Templates
- Colour palette
- Typography files
- Consent forms
- Social media assets
- Video templates

11. Compliance & Monitoring

To ensure consistent branding, quality assurance, and alignment Digital Democracy Initiative standards, all communications outputs will undergo periodic review.

Compliance checks will assess:

- Accuracy of logo placement
- Use of correct font families and size hierarchy
- Alignment with colour palette
- Use of approved templates
- Adherence to messaging guidelines
- Photographic and video consent compliance
- Accuracy, tone, and formatting in reports and publications
- Appropriate visibility for Digital Democracy Initiative and implementing partners



11.1 Post-Event Documentation Requirements

Every implementing partner and internal team must submit the following items within three working days after each event, workshop, training, consultation, roundtable, or any other project activity as per the approved workplan:

Attendance Sheet

- Signed physical attendance sheet OR digital attendance record
- Attendance sheets will also be shared in Excel spreadsheet format with the activity report
- Should include full names, gender, organization, designation, and contact information

Agenda of the Event

- Final agenda for the activity
- Must include event title, timings, speakers/facilitators, and partners' branding
- Editable version preferred for archiving

Consent for Digital Content

- Signed consent from all participants recorded during activity

High-Resolution Photos

- Minimum 10–15 HD photos with captions
- Must include wide shots, close-ups, action shots, and branding visibility
- No filters, watermarks, or heavy editing

Event Video Highlights

- Short video (30–90 seconds) summarizing key moments
- Clean audio and stable footage
- Must include correct logo placement for opening/closing frames

Testimonials with Subtitles

- 2–4 on-camera participant testimonials
- English subtitles required
- Subtitles must follow branding typography standards

Promotional Poster / Banner Used During the Event

- Final version in PNG/JPG
- Editable file (AI/PSD/Canva link)
- Logos must follow placement rules

Collateral Designs

- Agenda, backdrop, standees, certificates, name tags, folders, etc.
- Final + editable versions



- Must follow the approved branding guidelines

Social Media Tracking

- Screenshots and analytics
- Reach, impressions, engagement, and link performance
- Hashtag usage and audience demographics where available

12. Assets

Logos

Digital Democracy Initiative



Digital Democracy Initiative

CIVICUS



DDI South Asia (Regular)



DDI South Asia (Black)





DDI South Asia (White)



Accountability Lab (Regular)



Accountability Lab (to be used on dark coloured backgrounds)





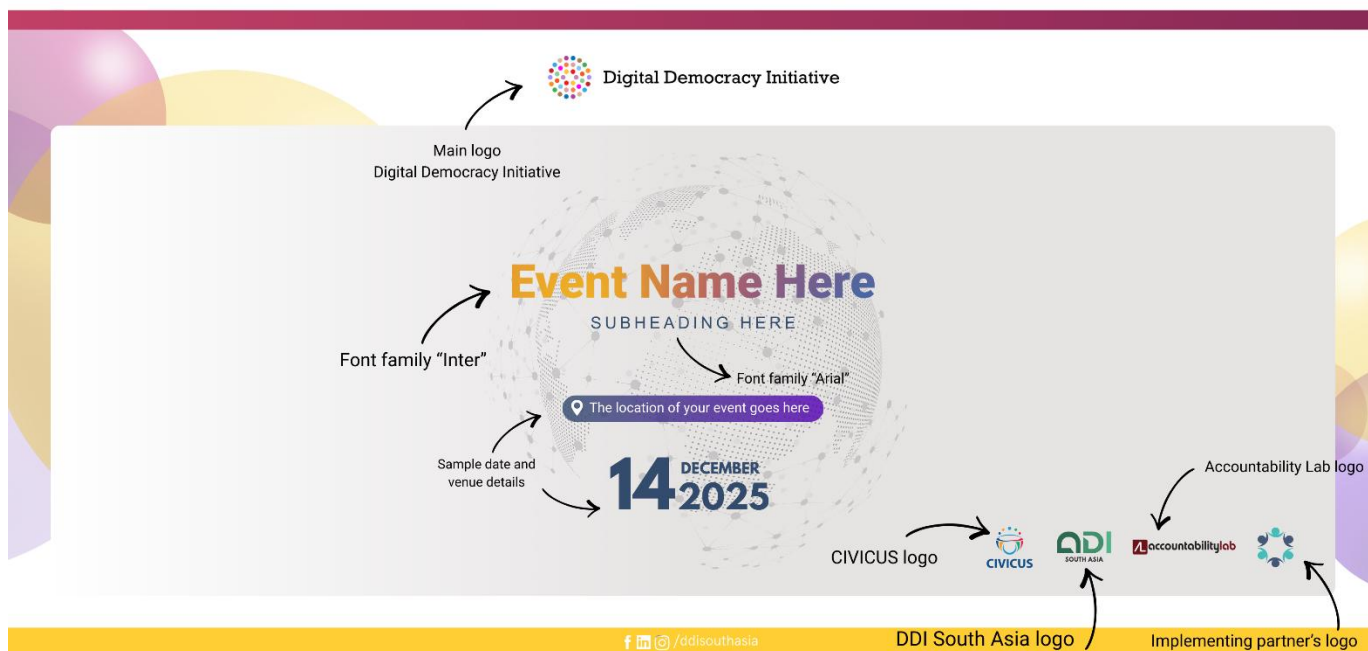
13. Samples

Event Standee





Event Backdrop



Certificate



Social Media Poster



Note: These sample designs are just for the understanding. You can choose to design your collateral in a different way in accordance with branding guidelines.